

# Dynasty Chronicle

A Publication from the Desk of the Commissioner

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## New Year, Same ED

Drew Gilmore

Here we go again, folks; the ED begins its eleventh season. When Facebook was in its eleventh year of operation, it was said to be worth around 230 big B's—following a somewhat similar trajectory, the ED is now valued at roughly \$6.23. In simple terms, if a stranger offered me \$6.23 in cash, I'd pull the plug on this whole charade right now. Sure, if the ED were to be acquired (talk about a distressed asset), you may get a few less phone calls from Marcus each year, but you'd also rid yourself of the annual anxiety of contemplating the handful of abysmal rookies you have to (I mean "get to") add to your roster even though they make your team "younger" and "add depth" to your heinous franchise. You wouldn't have to confusingly scroll the 136 new text messages that came in while you "unplugged" for a few minutes to take a surprisingly painful piss (there's medicine for that, you know!) and parse the paragraphs of vitriol and slander to find that yes, we are indeed changing everything next year (plot twist: we won't, we never will) because Marcus snorted Instant Hydration (keep count, Jordan; I will hit my quota) at 2 a.m. and concocted a solution that will solve all our problems, encourage engagement, save the whales, guarantee the apocalypse, etc. We've all had enough of this, right? Clearly not. We can't put this fantasy crack pipe down and dry ourselves out, and that's okay. Now that I've cleared my head, let's look ahead at what this next season might have in store for us...

I'll start where all good things start: somewhere near the middle. Jordan Menard's San Diego Orcas (good call on avoiding the deeply insensitive "killer whale" motif) will surely be looking to escape ED purgatory this year with a dark horse roster that could go big this year. Gamblers were relieved when Menard hit the over\* on trying to draft 3 players that had been taken at least 2 rounds prior. Despite this, Menard was able to walk away with some promising young talent in Tetaroia McMillan & Kaleb Johnson, which will certainly lead to a few dozen phone calls from Marcus at peculiar hours of the night.

Moving one step closer to the bottom, Carter Roberts' Moonlight Indians (talk about dressing for the job you want, not the job you have with the whole "Moonlight" thing) showed out in a big way at this year's draft. Roberts shocked the world—and by "world" I mean a few people in Cody's backyard—with taking two QB's in the first round, something the ED has never seen. The fun didn't stop there as Tyler "Kirkland Brand Brock Bowers" Warren fell to him at the 13<sup>th</sup> pick. Legend has it that every time a premier tight end is drafted by another team, a remnant of Marcus's soul slips into the underworld, and that held true at Monday's draft. Like the Orca's, the Indians certainly have the firepower to make waves this season, and we'll likely see Robert's draft day wealth diminish next year.

Speaking of gentlemen who've had to do Kyle O'Keefe's dishes after he left them out to "soak", Isaac Williams, the league's self-proclaimed healthiest member, has been climbing up the ladder of life recently and deserves some recognition... That said, this publication is committed to strictly reporting facts and speaking truth to power, so we will not be doing any "meat riding"\*\*\* as Mson refers to it. Additionally, if you measure success in the merely carnal terms of purchasing a single-family home in Vista then this league is starting to look like the guest list of the Met Gala, and Williams doesn't deserve a gold star for being able to save some cash by bringing a quesadilla to events like his mother-in-law's 60<sup>th</sup> birthday dinner at Eddie V's enough times to buy a home. All that said, we're happy for the guy, but would rather get spanked upside down by a dominatrix than have to manage his team. This offseason, Williams figured morale might tick up with a spicy rebrand; what would be a suitable mascot for the perennial rebuild? A banshee. If you're like me and need a refresher on what a banshee actually is, let me educate you. A Banshee, from Irish folklore, literally translates to "woman of the fairyland" or "fairy woman". Nope, your eyes have not deceived you. Better yet, the Banshee is most known to herald the death of a family member by "screaming, wailing, or shrieking". So, there you have it, Williams' team is bunch of screaming lady fairies. Feel free to make your own assumptions from there. For the love of everything let's move on.

Let's just get Marcus over with. The long-tenured "Vista Sequoias" are no more, and sadly the brand never made it to the league's hardware. Standing atop the Sequoia's shallow grave is a new identity that gives us an insight into Marcus's psyche. We'll dissect this word by word. First, "South": Marcus has long maintained that contrary to literally everything, that Southern California is part of the South. Yes, it's exactly what it sounds like, there's nothing deeper there. Marcus prides himself on being a contrarian in the realm of deeply fringe miscellaneous takes, so this is right where he wants to be. Second, "California": though Marcus does indeed live in California, and is therefore abiding by the league's regional requirements, California is a thorn in his intellectual side. Marcus lives under a crushing weight of having to pay taxes to a liberal police state that Candace Owens constantly urges him to defiantly leave. To many Americas, Marcus's front yard is likely filled with "In this house we believe science is real" yard signs. Identifying with California, for Marcus, is a reality he fights to avoid by devoting hours of his life to video games. Lastly, "Blackskins": this is a fascinating summary of Marcus's self-realization. This combines a homage to Marcus's biological lineage with a tribute to the NFL franchise he so randomly gave himself to in his youth. The name combines the clarity and chaos Marcus exists in. "Black" represents who and what Marcus has been his whole life, even when it was abstracted away from him in childhood. "Skins" acknowledges that, at the end of the day, Marcus contains multitudes and loyalty to a DC-based team was a welcome—albeit strange—refuge for a young black man being raised by Swedes in La Costa Valley. Thus, the South California

Blackskins may very well be the most aptly named franchise in this league. It should also be mentioned that Marcus acquired Josh Allen and Derrick Henry in the offseason and that is totally fine.

Just as you cannot play a bass guitar without an amplifier, you cannot speak of Marcus without also speaking of Kyle O’Keefe. O’Keefe, whether you like it or not, is currently the only guy in this group who gets to say “come and take it” after winning it all last year. Sadly, O’Keefe has yet to hoist the trophy due to “tariff restrictions” cited by prior champion Cody Scheiwe in what has turned into somewhat of an offseason scandal and has ignited a conversation about what really goes into shipping something that weighs like four pounds across the country, but nevertheless, the victory put some serious wind in his sails that can hopefully push him to more success this year. O’Keefe’s 2025 success will undoubtedly have to ride on the back of Commanders QB Jayden Daniels (doesn’t it seem like everyone is named “Jayden” these days?), so it’s really up to O’Keefe to avoid a “Yankee Clipper” type situation and not accidentally drop a keg of cold brew on one of Daniels’ feet while frantically trying to dap him up despite a security guard sinking a 3 inch needle in his back to subdue him after multiple warnings. Should the aforementioned scenario occur, Kyle can certainly bank on the high floor of his 2<sup>nd</sup> round draft pick Jase McClellan to keep the lights on, talk about some Jedi mind tricks with that pick!

Speaking of former champions, we move on to Cal Roberts and the Vallecitos Snowmen. A team I always have a hard time psychoanalyzing this time of year. Is the team good? Yes. Does the roster have depth, and can it go nuclear on any given Sunday? Yes. Does Roberts draft and trade shrewdly with a focus on value? Of course. Do the fantasy gods reward any of these virtues? Hell f—ing no. Roberts, in recent years, has been predestined to a cryptic fate of watching Jalen Hurts score 42 fantasy points each week while his faith in the core tenets of competition and skill erodes into ruin. The only antidote to this affliction is getting his rocks off to Ohio State beating Bowling Green 84-0. The question we should all be pondering is this: what happens when Lamar and Jalen (doesn’t it seem like everyone is named “Jalen” these days?) finally bring Cal to the precipice of his own sanity? How many tush pushes can Cal stomach before he decides to burn Isaac’s beautiful new home to the ground because of the simple satisfaction of seeing fire defeat wood & stone because it’s “simply more talented”? How many days of winter are left for the Snowmen?

Let’s take a moment now to acknowledge and laud our league’s founder Mason Burns. By “founder” I simply mean the guy who was closest to a computer when the real decisions makers decided it was time to give birth to a fantasy league. Somebody tell Pacha his village isn’t getting destroyed after all because the San Marcos Emperors have a new groove this year. Just kidding, they’re sticking to their tried-and-true script of hanging all potential success on a highly venerated rookie on a terrible team. For Burns, drafting Anthony Richardson was like buying a brand-new Mercedes G500 but then finding out the thing doesn’t run, and now you have an unclean spirit living in your home; now he’s got \$100k collecting dust in the garage, and he hasn’t slept in months because of the whole “haunted house” thing. Could Jeanty be the exorcist Burns so deeply desires? Should he finally sell the G500 for parts and buy a used Camry? Perhaps. No one would argue that Burns’ success would be great for the ED; let’s hope that sentiment can lead this horse to water in hopes it’ll drink.

Now to touch on to some sensitive news mentioned earlier: Cody Scheiwe, head of the Rancho Vista Ponies, has come under scrutiny for hoarding the ED trophy. Critics and analysts have had a variety of takes on what would lead a man to desire to keep an object of such little monetary or even sentimental value. One outlet had reported a theory based on leaked text messages from Scheiwe to an undisclosed African-american league member that Scheiwe had developed a relationship with the trophy that kept him from wanting to share it. At first, the messages were written off as fabricated because of their extreme and erotic nature, but sources were able to confirm the validity with the recipient. In these messages, Scheiwe admitted that his relationship with the trophy had “gone beyond material” and had become “physically essential”. It was implied in later messages that Scheiwe, while working from his Vista home, had begun using the bowl at the top of trophy as a makeshift lavatory while stuck in long Zoom meetings in his garage. This habit evolved into Scheiwe using the trophy as his sole outlet for expelling his waste. Around this time, Scheiwe began to publicly comment on the heightened cost of shipping the trophy to O’Keefe, who lives in that sketchy town where they filmed “The Wire” (or somewhere like that). Scheiwe also proposed the idea of replacing the trophy on several occasions, which ultimately did not gain traction. While Scheiwe has not given a comment on the matter to The Chronicle, we can confidently report that he has gone full Buffalo Bill with this thing and any future champions have little reason to believe they’ll be seeing that trophy any time soon. With that said, Cody would certainly love to dodge the heat on this matter by winning again this year, which might buy him a bit of breathing room on the whole “I’m addicted to pooping in the league trophy after my kids are in bed” situation. This publication has high hopes for him and expect to see him in the playoffs again this year, especially if he’s able to win a big trade down the stretch.

We’ll round this out with Noah May, the league’s resident closer. Speaking of closing, Noah closed on a bunch of old farts at the draft this year, including drafting a guy who retired less than a week later, something you don’t often see happen after a rookie draft. May drafted from a Palm Springs hotel room (two shirtless guys in the background included); likely as an attempt to generate some cheap alpha by changing the scenery. He walked away from the draft the same way most single men walk away from a night out in Palm Springs: with a conscience burdened by irrelevant old men. Now, we’ll give credit to May for getting in on the Isaac-offloading-best-players sweepstakes this year and landing Malik Nabers, which can be a piece he has a chance to really build on, but May still has noteworthy gaps he needs his roster to bridge this year if he wants to graduate to the next tier of ED talent.

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*\*\* The only meat the Chronicle will be riding this year is from the sponsor of this week’s publication: Butcher Box. Are you tired of going to the store to purchase meat like the mid suburban luddite you swore you’d never become? Well Butcher Box fixes that by mailing meat to your house for a higher price. Go to Butcher Box dot com and tell ‘em we sent you and they’ll throw in an extra 5lb of grass-fed silver skin compressed into the shape of a football.*